

Subnational Politics Project (SPP) Codebook (v.0.2)

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Suggested Citation for Each Database

Database Name	Abbreviation	Suggested Citation
Subnational Executive Database	SED	Giraudy, Agustina, Sergio Huertas, Francisco Urdinez. 2025. <i>Subnational Executive Database</i> (v.0.1). [DOI to be assigned]
Subnational Executive Elections Database	SEED	Giraudy, Agustina, Sergio Huertas, Francisco Urdinez. 2025. <i>Subnational Executive Elections Database</i> (v.0.1). [DOI to be assigned]
Subnational Legislative Elections Database	SLED	Giraudy, Agustina and Guadalupe, González. 2025. <i>Subnational Legislatures Database</i> (v.0.1). [DOI to be assigned]
Subnational Democracy Index	SDI	Giraudy, Agustina. 2025. <i>Subnational Democracy Index</i> (v.0.1). [DOI to be assigned]

Capital Federal & Tierra del Fuego Legislatures Database	CFTDFLD	Giraudy, Agustina and Guadalupe, González. 2025. <i>Subnational Legislatures Database</i> (v.0.1). [DOI to be assigned]
National Executive Database	NED	Giraudy, Agustina. 2025. <i>National Executive Database</i> (v.0.1). [DOI to be assigned]

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Introduction

The *Subnational Politics Project* (SPP) is part of a broader research project designed to compile, generate, and disseminate systematic, transparent, and publicly accessible data on subnational political institutions, subnational political processes, and subnational electoral outcomes in Latin America. The primary objective of the project is to create a centralized and standardized data infrastructure that facilitates both in-depth within-country analyses and cross-national comparative research on subnational political dynamics. By providing longitudinal and spatially disaggregated data, the SPP seeks to support empirical scholarship on a wide range of topics, including federalism, decentralization, party competition, electoral accountability, and territorial governance.

This codebook outlines the coding strategies, data sources, and variable construction protocols employed in the development of the SPP databases. As of July 2025, the project includes comprehensive databases for three federal countries in Latin America—Argentina, Brazil, and Mexico—covering the period from the 1980s through 2024 (see Table 1 for detailed country-specific information)

Project Overview

Objectives

- Document subnational political processes within Argentina, Brazil, and Mexico
- Enable comparative analysis of subnational governance patterns
- Provide users with standardized data on subnational elections and subnational political dynamics
- Support studies on subnational politics, federalism, political regimes, territorial politics, and political development

Databases' Structure

As Figure 1 shows, the *Subnational Politics Project* is made up of different databases.

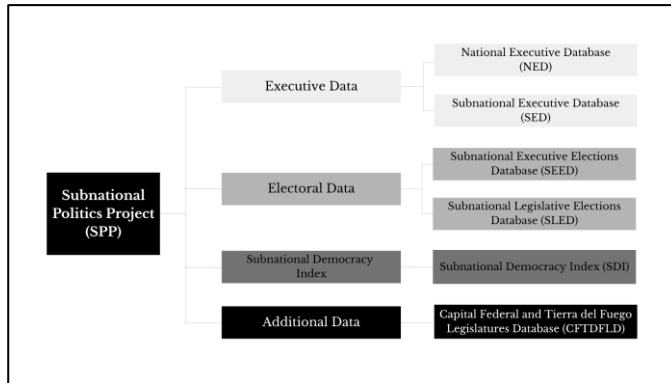


Fig 1: Diagram of the distribution of databases in SPP

Each database employs a country-state-year structure, with observations at the subnational unit level for each electoral year. Each observation represents a subnational unit (province/state) in a given year.

Intellectual Property

Variables taken directly from external sources, with no original coding beyond possible imputation of missing data, are not considered products of the *Subnational Politics Project*. In contrast, when data are drawn from multiple sources and combined in a way that involves analytical judgment, mathematical alteration, or aggregation, the resulting variable is classified as a *Subnational Politics Project* product.

Quality Assurance

All data have undergone rigorous verification processes:

1. **Primary Source Verification:** All data cross-checked with official electoral records
2. **Academic Validation:** Comparison with established academic datasets, where available
3. **Multiple Source Confirmation:** Key variables verified through multiple independent sources
4. **Temporal Consistency Checks:** Longitudinal data reviewed for consistency and logical progression

Country Coverage and Temporal Scope

Table 1: Coverage by Country

Country	Subnational Units	Executive Elections, data collection start in:	Legislative Election, data collection start in	Temporal Coverage	Total Observations
Argentina	24 provinces	1983	1983	1983-2024	~985
Brazil	27 federal units	1998	1998	1998-2024	~730
Mexico	32 federal entities	1985	1985	1985-2024	~1,280

Notes on Coverage

Argentina: Data for most provinces start in 1983, coinciding with the country’s return to democracy. Data for Tierra del Fuego and Ciudad Autónoma de Buenos Aires (formerly Capital Federal) and begin in 1991 and 1996, respectively, when these two subnational jurisdictions acquired the same legal status as all other provinces.

Brazil: Electoral data for all 27 federal units begin in 1998, the earliest year for which systematically verified data are available. The database is compiled primarily from records of the *Tribunal Superior Eleitoral* and cross-validated using the ElectionsBR database (Meireles et al., 2016).

Mexico: The general starting point for data collection is 1985, though coverage varies across federal entities due to the country’s staggered democratization process. The following states are included beginning in the corresponding years:

- 1986: Durango, Sinaloa, Tlaxcala, Tamaulipas
- 1988: Morelos, Jalisco
- 1991: San Luis Potosí
- 1992: Zacatecas, Oaxaca
- 1993: Nayarit, Hidalgo
- 1995: Yucatán
- 1997: Mexico City (CDMX)

Variable Information

As Figure 2 shows, the databases in the *Subnational Politics Project* divide variables into the following variable types:

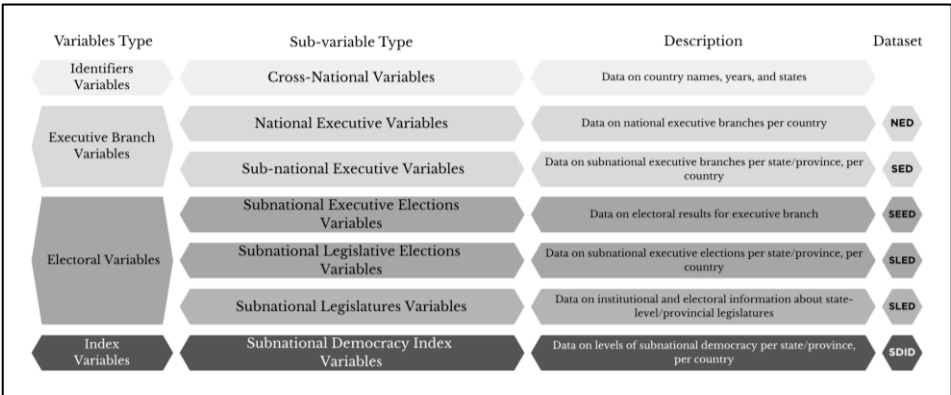


Fig 2: Diagram of the variables and the corresponding database

These variables offer the following information:

- Identifier Variables:** Data identifying country names and codes, state names and codes, region names, and time periods
- Executive Branch Variables:** Data on national and subnational executive branches, such as length of term, incumbent party, cumulative years of president/governor in office, etc.
- Electoral Variables:** Data on subnational executive, and subnational legislative elections, including legislatures' composition
- Indices:** Data generated by adding and combining variables, or creating cumulative scales

Identifier Variables

country_name

- **Description:** Name of the country
- **Type:** Categorical
- **Values:** ARGENTINA, BRAZIL, MEXICO
- **Source:** Own elaboration

country_code

- **Description:** ISO 3166-1 numeric country code
- **Type:** Categorical
- **Values:** 032 (Argentina), 076 (Brazil), 484 (Mexico)
- **Source:** ISO 3166-1 Standard

Comentado [1]: Mi sugerencia es que el country_code sea alfabético no numérico. Creo que es más común ver bases de datos con country_code alfabéticos que numéricos

Comentado [2]: Ordenar alfabéticamente?

Comentado [3R2]: No entiendo bien la pregunta/comentario. Porque ya están los países ordenados alfabéticamente según el country_code/country_code_numeric

state_name

- **Description:** Name of the subnational unit (province/state)
- **Type:** Categorical
- **Note:** See Appendix A for a complete list of subnational units by country
- **Source:** Official administrative records

state_code

- **Description:** Numeric code for subnational unit within country
- **Type:** Categorical
- **Note:** Follows official coding systems used by each country's electoral authorities. See Appendix B for a complete list of subnational codes
- **Source:** National electoral agencies

country_state_code

- **Description:** Combined country and state code (country_code + state_code)
- **Type:** Categorical
- **Format:** 5-digit numeric code
- **Note:** List of codes available in Appendix B
- **Source:** Own elaboration based on official codes

region_name

- **Description:** Geographic region within country
- **Type:** Categorical
- **Note:** Regional classifications follow established geographic divisions for each country
- **Source:** Official geographic classifications

year

- **Description:** Calendar year of observation
 - **Type:** Numeric
 - **Range:** 1983-2024 (varies by country)
 - **Source:** Own elaboration
-

Executive Branch Variables

National Executive

name_head_nat_exe

- **Description:** Name of the head of state (President)
- **Type:** Text
- **Source:** World Statesmen (worldstatesmen.org) and V-Dem

sex_head_nat_exe

- **Description:** Gender of the head of state
- **Type:** Binary
- **Values:**
 - 0 = Male
 - 1 = Female
- **Source:** Own elaboration

start_date_head_nat_exe

- **Description:** Start date of the presidential term, in year-month-day format
- **Type:** Date
- **Format:** yyyy-mm-dd (ISO 8601 standard)
- **Source:** V-Dem

end_date_head_nat_exe

- **Description:** End date of the presidential term, in year-month-day format
- **Type:** Date
- **Format:** yyyy-mm-dd (ISO 8601 standard)
- **Source:** V-Dem

term_length_in_years_nat_exe

- **Description:** Total duration of the president's current term in office

- **Type:** Numeric
- **Unit:** Years (decimal values allowed)
- **Measurement Logic:** Static value representing the complete length of the presidential term, repeated for each year of that term
- **Note:** For a 4-year presidential term, this variable shows "4" in each year of that presidency (years 1, 2, 3, and 4 all show "4")
- **Example:**
 - Brazil, Lula's first term (2003-2006): years_nat_gov = 4.0 for all years 2003, 2004, 2005, 2006
 - Mexico, AMLO's term (2018-2024): years_nat_gov = 6.0 for all years 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024
- **Source:** World Statesmen and V-Dem

reelec_nat_exe

- **Description:** Indicates presidential reelection
- **Type:** Binary
- **Values:**
 - 1 = Head of government has been reelected
 - 0 = Otherwise
- **Source:** Own elaboration with V-Dem information

early_exit_nat_exe

- **Description:** Indicates whether the president left office before completing their constitutional term
- **Type:** Binary
- **Values:**
 - 1 = Early departure from office (due to resignation, death, impeachment, removal, or other causes)
 - 0 = Completed full constitutional term or still in office
- **Note:** Includes all forms of premature departure regardless of cause.
 - Raúl Ricardo Alfonsín (Argentina) had an early exit on 1989, this was not added to the database.
- **Source:** Own elaboration

Comentado [4]: Te parece bien agregarlo así, Agus?

head_party_nat_exe

- **Description:** Political party of the president
- **Type:** Categorical
- **Source:** World Statesmen and V-Dem

ideo_party_nat_exe

- **Description:** Ideological classification of the president's political party
- **Type:** Ordinal

- **Values:**
 - 1 = Left
 - 2 = Center-left
 - 3 = Center-right
 - 4 = Right
 - [blank] = Independent or no political affiliation
- **Note:** Classification based on party platforms and programs, not implemented policies
- **Examples:**
 - **Left (1):** Brazil's PT (Partido dos Trabalhadores) under Lula/Dilma 2003-2016
 - **Center-left (2):** Argentina's FREPASO or Brazil's PSB in coalition governments
 - **Center-right (3):** Argentina's UCR (Unión Cívica Radical) or Brazil's PSDB
 - **Right (4):** Mexico's PAN (Partido Acción Nacional) 2000-2012, Argentina's PRO under Macri
 - **Independent [blank]:** Rare at presidential level in these countries
- **Source:** Coppedge (1997), Szajkowski (2005), Murillo et al. (2010), party websites

Comentado [5]: Missing in Reference section

Comentado [6R5]: Lo agregué. Pregunta: Te parece que esta referencia es consistente con el sistema de citación que tienen las otras citas en la reference section? Me quedó la duda cuando la agregué

year_election_nat_exe

- **Description:** Indicates whether national presidential elections were held during the year
- **Type:** Binary
- **Values:**
 - 1 = Presidential election year
 - 0 = Otherwise
- **Source:** Electoral agencies: argentina.gob.ar/dine, ine.mx, tse.jus.br

cumulative_years_in_power_nat_exe

- **Description:** Indicates the total number of years the president has held executive office, including previous experience in subnational executive positions.
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Example:** Carlos Saúl Menem (Argentina) had accumulated 7 years in executive office by 1989, the year he assumed the presidency. He served as Governor of La Rioja from 1983 to 1989 (6 years). His 7th year corresponds to the beginning of his presidential term.
- **Source:** Own elaboration

Comentado [7]: Esto te parece bien Agus según lo que hablamos?

Subnational Executive

name_head_sub_exe

- **Description:** Name of head of subnational state (Governor)
- **Type:** Text
- **Source:** For Argentina: Andy Tow's data verified by Tulia Falleti correspondence (04/21/2023). For other countries: subnational electoral information and state web portals

sex_head_sub_exe

- **Description:** Gender of the subnational head of government
- **Type:** Binary
- **Values:**
 - 0 = Male
 - 1 = Female
- **Source:** Own elaboration

start_date_head_sub_exe

- **Description:** Start date of the subnational government, in year-month-day format
- **Type:** Date
- **Format:** yyyy-mm-dd (ISO 8601 standard)
- **Source:** V-Dem

end_date_head_sub_exe

- **Description:** End date of the subnational government, in year-month-day format
- **Type:** Date
- **Format:** yyyy-mm-dd (ISO 8601 standard)
- **Source:** V-Dem

term_length_in_years_sub_exe

- **Description:** Total duration of the governor's term in office
- **Type:** Numeric
- **Unit:** Years (decimal values allowed)
- **Measurement Logic:** Static value representing the complete length of the gubernatorial term, repeated for each year of that term
- **Note:** For a 4-year gubernatorial term, this variable shows "4" in each year of that governorship (years 1, 2, 3, and 4 all show "4"). Value remains constant throughout the entire term.
- **Example:**
 - Buenos Aires, María Eugenia Vidal (2015-2019): years_sub_gov = 4.0 for all years 2015, 2016, 2017, 2018, 2019
 - São Paulo, João Doria (2019-2022, early departure): years_sub_gov = 3.0 for all years 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022 (reflecting actual time served)

Measurement Rules:

- Regular terms: Total constitutional term length
- Early exits: Actual time served until exit
- Successions: Time from assumption to end of term
- **Source:** Own coding based on official electoral data

change_head_sub_exe

- **Description:** Change in subnational head of government
- **Type:** Binary

Comentado [8]: No me queda claro esto

Comentado [9R8]: Rarísima e innecesaria esta última parte! Yo la eliminaría

Dio formato: Fuente: Negrita

Con formato

- **Values:**
 - 1 = Year when change occurred
 - 0 = Otherwise
- **Note:** Refers to any type of change, including succession due to early exit/federal intervention/death/etc.
- **Source:** Own elaboration

cumulative_changes_head_sub_exe

- **Description:** Cumulative count of gubernatorial changes since start of data series
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Range:** 0 to n (where n = total changes observed)
- **Note:** Increments of 1, each time a new governor comes to power, including interim or new appointment (due to early exit)
- **Measurement:** Cumulative count from first year of data coverage for each state
- **Example:**
 - **Buenos Aires Province, 1983-2023:**
 - 1983: Felipe Solá becomes governor (cumulative_changes_head_sub = 1)
 - 1987: Antonio Cafiero takes office (cumulative_changes_head_sub = 2)
 - 1991: Eduardo Duhalde elected (cumulative_changes_head_sub = 3)
 - 1999: Carlos Ruckauf takes office (cumulative_changes_head_sub = 4)
 - 2002: Felipe Solá returns to office (cumulative_changes_head_sub = 5)
 - 2007: Daniel Scioli elected (cumulative_changes_head_sub = 6)
 - 2015: María Eugenia Vidal takes office (cumulative_changes_head_sub = 7)
 - 2019: Axel Kicillof elected (cumulative_changes_head_sub = 8)
- **Source:** Own elaboration

early_exit_sub_exe

- **Description:** Indicates early exit from subnational executive office
- **Type:** Binary
- **Values:**
 - 1 = Early exit (resignation, death, impeachment, etc.)
 - 0 = Otherwise
- **Source:** Own elaboration

reelec_sub_exe

- **Description:** Governor reelection
- **Type:** Binary
- **Values:**
 - 1 = Governor was reelected (won election for consecutive term)
 - 0 = Governor was not reelected (first term, term-limited, or defeated)
 - [blank] = Not applicable (e.g., Mexico where gubernatorial reelection is prohibited)

- **Note:** Only codes direct reelection to consecutive terms, not returns to office after intervals
- **Source:** Own elaboration

years_contin_sub_exe

- **Description:** Total number of years that governor has served across all terms in office
- **Type:** Numeric
- **Unit:** Years (decimal values allowed)
- **Measurement Logic:**
 - **Single term governors:** Same value as years_sub_gov
 - **Multi-term governors:** Cumulative years across all terms served by the same individual
 - **Interrupted tenure:** Includes break across terms if same person returns to office
- **Note:** Tracks individual tenure regardless of party changes or electoral defeats followed by comebacks
- **Example:**
 - **São Paulo, Brazil - Geraldo Alckmin:**
 - 2001-2006: First term (years_sub_gov_contin = 5.0 in 2006)
 - 2007-2010: Second consecutive term (years_sub_gov_contin = 9.0 in 2010)
 - 2011-2018: Third consecutive term (years_sub_gov_contin = 17.0 in 2018)
 - **Comparison with hypothetical successor:**
 - 2019: New governor takes office (years_sub_gov_contin = 1.0 in 2019)
- **Source:** Own coding based on electoral agencies

head_party_sub_exe

- **Description:** Political party of subnational head of government
- **Type:** Categorical
- **Source:** Electoral agencies

years_party_contin_sub_exe

- **Description:** Total number of years that governor has served across all terms in office as part of the party
- **Type:** Numeric
- **Unit:** Years (decimal values allowed)
- **Measurement Logic:**
 - **Single term governors:** Same value as years_sub_gov
 - **Multi-term governors:** Cumulative years across all terms served by the same individual
 - **Interrupted tenure:** Includes break across terms if same person returns to office
- **Note:** Tracks individual tenure regardless of party changes or electoral defeats followed by comebacks

- **Source:** Own coding based on electoral agencies

ideo_party_sub_exe

- **Description:** Ideological classification of governor's political party
- **Type:** Ordinal
- **Values:**
 - 1 = Left
 - 2 = Center-left
 - 3 = Center-right
 - 4 = Right
 - [blank] = Independent or no political affiliation
- **Note:** Classification based on party platforms and programs
- **Source:** Coppedge (1997), Szajkowski (2005), Murillo et al. (2010), party websites

concurrent_with_nat_election_sub_exe

- **Description:** Indicates whether gubernatorial and presidential elections were held in the same calendar year
- **Type:** Binary
- **Values:**
 - 1 = Concurrent election year (both gubernatorial and presidential elections held)
 - 0 = Non-concurrent year (only one type of election or neither)
- **Measurement:** Based on calendar year, not exact election dates
- **Note:** Important for analyzing electoral coattail effects and vertical electoral coordination
- **Examples:**
 - **Concurrent (1):** Brazil, 2018 - All states elect governors in October alongside presidential election
 - **Concurrent (1):** Mexico, 2018 - 9 states (including CDMX, Jalisco, Morelos) hold gubernatorial elections same year as presidential
 - **Non-concurrent (0):** Argentina, 2017 - No presidential election, but several provinces (Buenos Aires, Córdoba, etc.) elect governors
 - **Non-concurrent (0):** Mexico, 2019 - No presidential election, but Baja California holds gubernatorial election
 - **Country patterns:** Brazil always concurrent (every 4 years), Argentina/Mexico mixed timing
- **Source:** Own coding based on electoral agencies

alignment_with_nat_executive

- **Description:** Indicates political alignment between national president and subnational governor
- **Type:** Binary
- **Values:**
 - 1 = Political alignment exists
 - 0 = No political alignment

- **Coding Criteria:** Following Giraudy (2015) and Niedzwiecki (2018), coded as 1 if any of the following conditions are met:
 - **Same party membership:** President and governor belong to the same political party
 - **Coalition partnership:** Governor's party is part of the president's legislative coalition at national level
 - **Political cooperation:** Despite different party affiliations, observable political affinity and cooperative behavior exists between president and governor
 - **Examples:**
 - **Criterion 1 - São Paulo, 2003:** PT President Lula + PT Governor José Genoino = 1 (same party)
 - **Criterion 2 - Santa Fe, Argentina, 2008:** PJ President Cristina Kirchner + PS Governor Hermes Binner = 1 (PS supports national government coalition)
 - **Criterion 3 - Nuevo León, Mexico, 2001:** PAN President Fox + Independent Governor Natividad González = 1 (cooperation despite different affiliations)
 - **No alignment - Córdoba, Argentina, 2017:** Cambiemos President Macri + PJ Governor Schiavetti = 0 (opposition parties, no cooperation)
 - **Note:** Focuses on political cooperation rather than strict party membership
 - **Source:** Own identification based on established methodology
-

Electoral Variables

Subnational Executive

winner_candidate_sub_exe

- **Description:** Name of the candidate who won and assumed office as governor
- **Type:** Text
- **Source:** For Argentina: Andy Tow's data verified by Tulia Falleti correspondence (04/21/2023). For other countries: subnational electoral information and state web portals

early_exit_sub_exe

- **Description:** Indicates early exit from subnational executive office
- **Type:** Binary
- **Values:**
 - 1 = Early exit (resignation, death, impeachment, etc.)
 - 0 = Otherwise
- **Source:** Own elaboration

reelec_sub_exe

- **Description:** Governor reelection
- **Type:** Binary
- **Values:**
 - 1 = Governor was reelected (won election for consecutive term)
 - 0 = Governor was not reelected (first term, term-limited, or defeated)
 - [blank] = Not applicable (e.g., Mexico where gubernatorial reelection is prohibited)
- **Note:** Only codes direct reelection to consecutive terms, not returns to office after intervals
- **Source:** Own elaboration

ideo_party_sub_exe

- **Description:** Ideological classification of governor's political party
- **Type:** Ordinal
- **Values:**
 - 1 = Left
 - 2 = Center-left
 - 3 = Center-right
 - 4 = Right
 - [blank] = Independent or no political affiliation
- **Note:** Classification based on party platforms and programs
- **Source:** Coppedge (1997), Szajkowski (2005), Murillo et al. (2010), party websites

electoral_year_sub_exe

- **Description:** Subnational executive election
- **Type:** Binary
- **Values:**
 - 1 = Election occurred
 - 0 = Otherwise
- **Source:** Own elaboration

cumulative_electoral_year_sub_exe

- **Description:** Cumulative count of subnational executive elections in the state
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Own elaboration

snap_election_sub_exe

- **Description:** Early subnational executive election
- **Type:** Binary
- **Values:**
 - 1 = Snap election occurred
 - 0 = Otherwise

- **Source:** Electoral agencies

date_election_sub_exe

- **Description:** Date of subnational executive electoral process
- **Type:** Date
- **Format:** yyyy-mm-dd (ISO 8601 standard)
- **Source:** Electoral agencies

voters_registered_sub_exe

- **Description:** Total registered voters for subnational executive election
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral agencies

total_voters_sub_exe

- **Description:** Total people who voted in subnational executive election
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Note:** Includes votes for parties, blank votes, and null votes
- **Source:** Electoral agencies

perc_voter_sub_exe

- **Description:** Voter turnout rate for subnational executive election
- **Type:** Numeric (percentage)
- **Formula:** $(\text{total_voters_sub} / \text{voters_registered_sub}) \times 100$
- **Source:** Calculated from electoral agencies data

valid_votes_sub_exe

- **Description:** Total valid votes for subnational executive election
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral agencies

perc_valid_votes_sub_exe

- **Description:** Valid votes as percentage of total votes
- **Type:** Numeric (percentage)
- **Formula:** $(\text{valid_votes_sub} / \text{total_voters_sub}) \times 100$
- **Source:** Calculated from electoral agencies data

invalid_votes_sub_exe

- **Description:** Total invalid/void votes for subnational executive election
- **Type:** Numeric (count)

Comentado [10]: Por favor revisar y (corregir cuando sea necesario) variables que se hayan calculado vs variables que se hayan imputado. Esta diferencia es importante por lo siguiente:

If we import a variable from another source without doing any original coding, except for perhaps imputing missing data, it is not considered a Subnational Politics Database product. If, however, we gather data from a number of sources and combine them in a more than purely mechanical fashion (requiring some judgment on our part), we regard this as a Subnational Politics Database product

- **Source:** Electoral agencies
- **perc_invalid_votes_sub_exe**
Description: Invalid votes as percentage of total votes
- **Type:** Numeric (percentage)
- **Formula:** $(\text{invalid_votes_sub} / \text{total_voters_sub}) \times 100$
- **Source:** Calculated from electoral agencies data

votes_candidate_winner_sub_exe

- **Description:** Total votes for winning gubernatorial candidate
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral agencies

perc_votes_winner_candidate_sub_exe

- **Description:** Vote share of winning gubernatorial candidate
- **Type:** Numeric (percentage)
- **Formula:** $(\text{votes_candidate_winner} / \text{valid_votes_sub}) \times 100$
- **Source:** Calculated from electoral agencies' data

second_place_votes_sub_exe

- **Description:** Total votes for second-place gubernatorial candidate
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral agencies

perc_second_place_sub_exe

- **Description:** Vote share of second-place gubernatorial candidate
- **Type:** Numeric (percentage)
- **Formula:** $(\text{second_place_votes} / \text{valid_votes_sub}) \times 100$
- **Source:** Calculated from electoral agencies data

last_place_votes_sub_exe

- **Description:** Total votes for last-place gubernatorial candidate
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral agencies

perc_last_place_sub_exe

- **Description:** Vote share of last-place gubernatorial candidate
- **Type:** Numeric (percentage)
- **Formula:** $(\text{last_place_votes} / \text{valid_votes_sub}) \times 100$
- **Source:** Calculated from electoral agencies' data

margin_victory_sub_exe

- **Description:** Victory margin in gubernatorial election
- **Type:** Numeric (percentage)
- **Formula:** winner_candidate_ratio - second_place_ratio
- **Source:** Calculated from electoral agencies data

num_parties_election_contest_sub_exe

- **Description:** Number of parties competing in gubernatorial election
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral agencies

enp_sub_exe

- **Description:** Effective Number of Parties competing in gubernatorial elections
- **Type:** Numeric (continuous)
- **Range:** 1.0 to n (where n = theoretical maximum based on number of candidates)
- **Formula:** $ENP = 1/\sum(\pi_i^2)$, where π_i is the vote share of party i
- **Calculation:** Based on Laakso and Taagepera (1979) index using vote shares of all competing parties
- **Interpretation:**
 - Values near 1.0 = dominant party system
 - Values near 2.0 = two-party competition
 - Higher values = more fragmented party system
- **Examples:**
 - **Dominant system (ENP ≈ 1.2):** Coahuila, Mexico, 2005 - PRI candidate wins with 89% vs. 8% PAN, 3% others
 - **Two-party competition (ENP ≈ 2.1):** São Paulo, Brazil, 2018 - PSDB 51.7% vs. PT 48.3% in runoff
 - **Fragmented system (ENP ≈ 3.8):** Buenos Aires, Argentina, 2015 - Cambiemos 35.4%, FPV 30.1%, Massa 20.8%, others 13.7%
 - **Highly fragmented (ENP ≈ 5.2):** CDMX, Mexico, 2018 - MORENA 32.1%, PAN 21.8%, PRD 15.4%, PRI 12.3%, others 18.4%
- **Source:** Calculated from electoral agencies data

Subnational Legislative

chamber_election_sub_leg

- **Description:** Chamber in which elections are held that year in the state
- **Type:** Categorical
- **Values:**

- 1 = Lower Chamber
 - 2 = Upper Chamber
- **Source:** Own elaboration

date_electoral_sub_leg

- **Description:** Date of subnational legislative electoral process
- **Type:** Date
- **Format:** yyyy-mm-dd (ISO 8601 standard)
- **Source:** Electoral agencies

voters_registered_sub_leg

- **Description:** Total registered voters for subnational legislative election
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral agencies

total_voters_sub_leg

- **Description:** Total people who voted in subnational legislative election
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Note:** Includes votes for parties, blank votes, and null votes
- **Source:** Electoral agencies

perc_voters_sub_leg

- **Description:** Voter turnout rate for subnational legislative election
- **Type:** Numeric (percentage)
- **Formula:** $(\text{total_voters_sub_leg} / \text{voters_registered_sub_leg}) \times 100$
- **Source:** Calculated from electoral agencies data

valid_votes_sub_leg

- **Description:** Total valid votes for subnational legislative election
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral agencies

perc_valid_votes_sub_leg

- **Description:** Valid votes as percentage of total votes in legislative election
- **Type:** Numeric (percentage)
- **Formula:** $(\text{valid_votes_sub_leg} / \text{total_voters_sub_leg}) \times 100$
- **Source:** Calculated from electoral agencies data

party_name_sub_leg

- **Description:** Name of the party or the electoral coalition that compete in Election
- **Type:** Text
- **Source:** Electoral agencies

Comentado [11]: Te parece bien usar 'electoral coalition'? o alliance?

total_votes_party_sub_leg

- **Description:** Total people who voted in subnational legislative election for that party/electoral coalition
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral agencies

perc_votes_party_sub_leg

- **Description:** Percentage of votes obtained in subnational legislative election for the party/electoral coalition
- **Type:** Numeric (percentage)
- **Formula:** $(\text{total_votes_party_sub_leg} / \text{valid_votes_sub_leg}) \times 100$
- **Source:** Electoral agencies

total_seats_party_sub_leg

- **Description:** Amount of seats obtained by the party/electoral coalition in subnational legislative election
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral agencies

perc_seats_party_sub_leg

- **Description:** Percentage of seats obtained by the party/alliance in the subnational legislative election
- **Type:** Numeric (percentage)
- **Formula:** $(\text{total_seats_party_sub_leg} / \text{total_seats_in_contest_sub_leg}) \times 100$
- **Source:** Electoral agencies

blank_votes_sub_leg

- **Description:** Number of blank votes in the subnational legislative election
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral agencies

null_votes_sub_leg

- **Description:** Number of null votes in the subnational legislative election
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral agencies

challenged_votes_sub_leg

- **Description:** Number of challenged votes in the subnational legislative election
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral agencies

impounded_votes_sub_leg

- **Description:** Number of contested voting identities in the subnational legislative election
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral agencies

compensation_for_record_discrepancy_votes_sub_leg

- **Description:** Number of votes offset by discrepancy in the tally sheets in the subnational legislative election
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral agencies

margin_victory_sub_leg

- **Description:** Victory margin in legislative election
- **Type:** Numeric (percentage)
- **Formula:** percentage of votes obtained by the winning party - percentage of votes obtained by the second-place party
- **Source:** Calculated from electoral agencies data

cumulative_electoral_year_sub_legcumulative_electoral_sub_year

- **Description:** Cumulative count of subnational executive elections
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Note:** Running total from beginning of data series
- **Source:** Own coding

concurrent_election_with_nat_sub_legconcurrent_sub_nat_election

- **Description:** Indicates whether gubernatorial and presidential elections were held in the same calendar year
- **Type:** Binary
- **Values:**
 - 1 = Concurrent election year (both gubernatorial and presidential elections held)
 - 0 = Non-concurrent year (only one type of election or neither)
- **Measurement:** Based on calendar year, not exact election dates
- **Note:** Important for analyzing electoral coattail effects and vertical electoral coordination
- **Examples:**

- **Concurrent (1):** Brazil, 2018 - All states elect governors in October alongside presidential election
- **Concurrent (1):** Mexico, 2018 - 9 states (including CDMX, Jalisco, Morelos) hold gubernatorial elections same year as presidential
- **Non-concurrent (0):** Argentina, 2017 - No presidential election, but several provinces (Buenos Aires, Córdoba, etc.) elect governors
- **Non-concurrent (0):** Mexico, 2019 - No presidential election, but Baja California holds gubernatorial election
- **Country patterns:** Brazil always concurrent (every 4 years), Argentina/Mexico mixed timing
- **Source:** Own coding based on electoral agencies

num_parties_election_contest_sub_leg

- **Description:** Number of parties that participated in the election to the subnational legislature
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Own coding based on electoral agencies

total_seats_in_contest_sub_leg

- **Description:** Number of parties competing in legislative election
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral agencies

total_chamber_seats_sub_leg

- **Description:** Total seats in lower/single chamber of subnational legislature
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Electoral agencies

num_seats_incumbent_sub_leg

- **Description:** Seats held by governor's party in subnational legislature
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Note:** Excludes coalition partners; only governor's own party
- **Source:** Electoral agencies

perc_seats_incumbent_sub_leg

- **Description:** Percentage of legislative seats held by the governor's political party
- **Type:** Numeric (percentage)
- **Range:** 0.0 to 100.0
- **Formula:** $(\text{num_seats_legislative_government} / \text{num_legislative_seats}) \times 100$
- **Measurement Rules:**
 - **Party identification:** Only counts seats won by the governor's exact party

- **Coalition exclusion:** Does not include allied or coalition parties
 - **Independent governors:** Coded as 0 when governor has no party affiliation
- **Interpretation:**
 - Values > 50.0 = Governor's party has legislative majority
 - Values < 50.0 = Governor's party in legislative minority
- **Examples:**
 - **Strong majority:** Veracruz, Mexico, 2016 - PAN Governor + 30 of 50 seats (60.0%)
 - **Bare majority:** Minas Gerais, Brazil, 2018 - NOVO Governor + 38 of 77 seats (49.4%)
 - **Weak minority:** Buenos Aires, Argentina, 2015 - Cambiemos Governor + 15 of 92 seats (16.3%)
 - **Coalition scenario:** Santa Fe, Argentina, 2019 - PJ Governor wins but allied parties hold additional seats not counted in this variable
 - **Independent governor:** Nuevo León, Mexico, 2015 - Independent Governor = 0.0% (no party affiliation)
- **Source:** Calculated from electoral agencies data

num_seats_opos_sub_leg

- **Description:** Seats held by opposition parties in subnational legislature
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Note:** Includes all parties opposing subnational government
- **Source:** Electoral agencies

perc_seats_opos_sub_leg

- **Description:** Percentage of legislative seats held by opposition
- **Type:** Numeric (percentage)
- **Formula:** $(\text{num_seats_legislative_opos} / \text{num_legislative_seats}) \times 100$
- **Source:** Calculated from electoral agencies data

enp_leg_sub_leg

- **Description:** Effective Number of Legislative Parties based on electoral vote shares
- **Type:** Numeric (continuous)
- **Range:** 1.0 to n (where n = theoretical maximum based on number of parties)
- **Formula:** $ENPL = 1/\sum(v_i^2)$, where v_i is the vote share of party i in legislative elections
- **Calculation:** Based on Laakso and Taagepera (1979) index using vote shares of all competing parties in subnational legislative elections
- **Interpretation:**
 - Values near 1.0 = dominant party system in legislature
 - Values near 2.0 = two-party competition
 - Higher values = more fragmented party system
- **Note:** Measures party system fragmentation at the electoral level (votes) rather than seat allocation

- **Source:** Calculated from electoral agencies data

chamber_sub_leg

- **Description:** Number of chambers in subnational legislature
- **Type:** Categorical
- **Values:**
 - 1 = Unicameral
 - 2 = Bicameral
- **Note:** Data captured for lower or single chamber only
- **Source:** Latest version of provincial constitutions until July 2025

term_length_in_years_sub_leg

- **Description:** Term length (in years) of legislators by July 2025
- **Type:** Numeric (count)
- **Source:** Latest version of provincial constitutions until July 2025

renewal_type_sub_leg

- **Description:** Type of renewal that the chamber has until July 2025
- **Type:** Categorical
- **Values:**
 - 1 = Staggered every 2 years
 - 2 = Full renewal
- **Source:** Latest version of provincial constitutions until July 2025

electoral_system_sub_leg

- **Description:** Type of electoral system that the chamber has as of July 2025
- **Type:** Categorical
- **Values:**
 - 1 = Proportional Representation
 - 2 = Simple Majority
 - 3 = Mixed (Proportional Representation and Simple Majority)
 - 4 = Mixed (Proportional Representation with predefined electoral districts)
- **Source:** Latest version of provincial constitutions until July 2025

Data Sources

Primary Sources

Argentina:

- Dirección Nacional Electoral (argentina.gob.ar/dine)
- Cámara Nacional Electoral
- Selected Provincial Electoral Tribunals
- Andy Tow's Electoral Repository (andytow.com)

Brazil:

- Tribunal Superior Eleitoral (tse.jus.br)
- ElectionsBR database (Meireles et al., 2016)
- State Electoral Tribunals

Mexico:

- Instituto Nacional Electoral (ine.mx)
- State Electoral Institutes (Instituto Electoral Estatal)

Appendices

Appendix A: Subnational Units by Country

Argentina (24 units)

Buenos Aires, Ciudad Autónoma de Buenos Aires, Catamarca, Chaco, Chubut, Córdoba, Corrientes, Entre Ríos, Formosa, Jujuy, La Pampa, La Rioja, Mendoza, Misiones, Neuquén, Río Negro, Salta, San Juan, San Luis, Santa Cruz, Santa Fe, Santiago del Estero, Tierra del Fuego, Tucumán

Brazil (27 units)

Acre, Alagoas, Amapá, Amazonas, Bahia, Ceará, Distrito Federal, Espírito Santo, Goiás, Maranhão, Mato Grosso do Sul, Mato Grosso, Minas Gerais, Pará, Paraíba, Paraná, Pernambuco, Piauí, Rio de Janeiro, Rio Grande do Norte, Rio Grande do Sul, Rondônia, Roraima, Santa Catarina, São Paulo, Sergipe, Tocantins

Mexico (32 units)

Aguascalientes, Baja California, Baja California Sur, Campeche, Ciudad de México, Chiapas, Chihuahua, Coahuila, Colima, Durango, Guanajuato, Guerrero, Hidalgo, Jalisco, México, Michoacán, Morelos, Nayarit, Nuevo León, Oaxaca, Puebla, Querétaro, Quintana Roo, San Luis Potosí, Sinaloa, Sonora, Tabasco, Tamaulipas, Tlaxcala, Veracruz, Yucatán, Zacatecas

Appendix B: State Codes by Country

Table B.1: Complete List of Subnational Units with Codes

Country	Country Code	State Name	State Code	Combined Code
ARGENTINA	032			
Argentina	032	BUENOS AIRES	06	03206
Argentina	032	CAPITAL FEDERAL	02	03202
Argentina	032	CATAMARCA	10	03210
Argentina	032	CHACO	22	03222
Argentina	032	CHUBUT	26	03226
Argentina	032	CORDOBA	14	03214
Argentina	032	CORRIENTES	18	03218
Argentina	032	ENTRE RIOS	30	03230
Argentina	032	FORMOSA	34	03234
Argentina	032	JUJUY	38	03238
Argentina	032	LA PAMPA	42	03242
Argentina	032	LA RIOJA	46	03246
Argentina	032	MENDOZA	50	03250
Argentina	032	MISIONES	54	03254
Argentina	032	NEUQUEN	58	03258
Argentina	032	RIO NEGRO	62	03262
Argentina	032	SALTA	66	03266
Argentina	032	SAN JUAN	70	03270
Argentina	032	SAN LUIS	74	03274
Argentina	032	SANTA CRUZ	78	03278
Argentina	032	SANTA FE	82	03282
Argentina	032	SANTIAGO DEL ESTERO	86	03286
Argentina	032	TIERRA DEL FUEGO	94	03294

Country	Country Code	State Name	State Code	Combined Code
Argentina	032	TUCUMAN	90	03290
BRAZIL	076			
Brazil	076	ACRE	12	07612
Brazil	076	ALAGOAS	27	07627
Brazil	076	AMAPA	16	07616
Brazil	076	AMAZONAS	13	07613
Brazil	076	BAHIA	29	07629
Brazil	076	CEARA	23	07623
Brazil	076	DISTRITO FEDERAL	53	07653
Brazil	076	ESPIRITO SANTO	32	07632
Brazil	076	GOIAS	52	07652
Brazil	076	MARANHAO	21	07621
Brazil	076	MATO GROSSO DO SUL	50	07650
Brazil	076	MATO GROSSO	51	07651
Brazil	076	MINAS GERAIS	31	07631
Brazil	076	PARA	15	07615
Brazil	076	PARAIBA	25	07625
Brazil	076	PARANA	41	07641
Brazil	076	PERNAMBUCO	26	07626
Brazil	076	PIAUI	22	07622
Brazil	076	RIO DE JANEIRO	33	07633
Brazil	076	RIO GRANDE DO NORTE	24	07624
Brazil	076	RIO GRANDE DO SUL	43	07643
Brazil	076	RONDÔNIA	11	07611
Brazil	076	RORAIMA	14	07614
Brazil	076	SANTA CATARINA	42	07642

Country	Country Code	State Name	State Code	Combined Code
Brazil	076	SAO PAULO	35	07635
Brazil	076	SERGIPE	28	07628
Brazil	076	TOCANTINS	17	07617
MEXICO	484			
Mexico	484	AGUASCALIENTES	01	48401
Mexico	484	BAJA CALIFORNIA	02	48402
Mexico	484	BAJA CALIFORNIA SUR	03	48403
Mexico	484	CAMPECHE	04	48404
Mexico	484	CDMX	09	48409
Mexico	484	CHIAPAS	07	48407
Mexico	484	CHIHUAHUA	08	48408
Mexico	484	COAHUILA	05	48405
Mexico	484	COLIMA	06	48406
Mexico	484	DURANGO	10	48410
Mexico	484	GUANAJUATO	11	48411
Mexico	484	GUERRERO	12	48412
Mexico	484	HIDALGO	13	48413
Mexico	484	JALISCO	14	48414
Mexico	484	MEXICO	15	48415
Mexico	484	MICHOACAN	16	48416
Mexico	484	MORELOS	17	48417
Mexico	484	NAYARIT	18	48418
Mexico	484	NUEVO LEON	19	48419
Mexico	484	OAXACA	20	48420
Mexico	484	PUEBLA	21	48421
Mexico	484	QUERETARO	22	48422

Country	Country Code	State Name	State Code	Combined Code
Mexico	484	QUINTANA ROO	23	48423
Mexico	484	SAN LUIS POTOSI	24	48424
Mexico	484	SINALOA	25	48425
Mexico	484	SONORA	26	48426
Mexico	484	TABASCO	27	48427
Mexico	484	TAMAULIPAS	28	48428
Mexico	484	TLAXCALA	29	48429
Mexico	484	VERACRUZ	30	48430
Mexico	484	YUCATAN	31	48431
Mexico	484	ZACATECAS	32	48432

Appendix C: Key References

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